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TAB 19



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-028-23/24, Version: 1

Dr. Rivas - Supporting Assembly Constitutional Amendment No. 16 (ACA 16), the Green Amendment, to Codify the Right to Clean Air, Water, and a Healthy Environment for Every Californian (Res-028-23/24) (For Action June 4, 2024)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District is committed to the health, well-being, and academic success of all students;

Whereas, The District has established a strong foundation for environmental stewardship through a series of impactful resolutions, including commitments to 100% clean energy (Res-018-19/20), extensive campus greening by 2035 (Res-002-22/23), and ensuring every student receives annual outdoor and climate literacy education (Res-016-21/22), demonstrating the District's unwavering dedication to fostering a healthy learning environment and a sustainable future for all;

Whereas, The District's 2022-26 Strategic Plan prioritizes student success in a sustainable future, the District recognizes the profound impact of a healthy environment on student learning and well-being, particularly through the development of safe and sustainable green spaces in schools as outlined in Pillar 2: Joy and Wellness - Welcoming Learning Environments;

Whereas, Students in low-income communities and communities of color are disproportionately impacted by environmental injustices, including higher levels of air and water pollution, limited access to green spaces, and the brunt of climate change effects;

Whereas, These environmental injustices negatively impact student health, leading to increased asthma rates, respiratory illnesses, and developmental problems;

Whereas, Access to clean air, water, and green spaces is crucial for students' cognitive function, stress reduction, and physical activity, all of which are essential for learning and development;

Whereas, ACA 16 (Bryan), also known as the Green Amendment, proposes to amend the California Constitution to establish a fundamental right to a clean and healthy environment for all Californians; and

Whereas, Enshrining this right in the state constitution would provide a stronger foundation for existing environmental legislation and guide future policy decisions that prioritize environmental justice and the health of all Californians; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby strongly supports the passage of ACA 16;

Resolved further, That the Board urges the California Legislature to pass ACA 16 and Governor

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Newsom to sign it into law; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Board hereby directs the Superintendent and the District's Office of Government Relations to transmit a copy of this Resolution to the Speaker of the Assembly, the President pro Tempore of the Senate, each member of the California State Legislature representing a district within the boundaries of the LAUSD, and Governor Newsom.